

Darby Athlete Recognized in 2025–2026 Shooting Challenge

By Coach Mike Schmidt / 127 Sports Intensity

BITTERROOT VALLEY — Lewis Talbitzer of Darby earned recognition in the 2025–2026 127 Sports Intensity Shooting Challenge, a level-based basketball development program that rewards shooting, consistency, homework, video feedback, Zoom participation, streaks, and accountability.

The challenge used a 12-level progression system. Beginner was Level 1, and G.O.A.T. was Level 12, the highest level in the program. Athletes advanced by combining counted shots with other development requirements.

Across the full challenge, athletes combined for 307,391 counted shots, nearly 2,000 submissions, 141 video submissions for form and technique feedback, and 142 passing homework assignments. Standings and challenge results can be viewed at fairfieldbasketballclub.com/leaderboard.

Talbitzer, a fourth-grade student at Darby, reached Beginner, Level 1 of 12, with 653 counted shots. He earned Thanks for Playing - Every Bit Counts recognition for participating in the challenge and logging his shooting work.

Coach Mike Schmidt, who runs the challenge through 127 Sports Intensity, said the program is designed to reward complete development.

“This challenge is not just about counting shots,” Schmidt said. “It is about learning how to show up, stay consistent, set goals, accept feedback, and keep working.”

Talbitzer’s participation showed one of the goals of the program: helping athletes begin the habit of doing the work, tracking it, and continuing to improve.